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MILLION-DOLLAR ESSAY-PROPOSITION, (NO. III)

We need not repeat Pilot's question here? We know what Jesus means by truth. Reason itself shows us that God is truth; and that it is of such a nature that for the normal mind to know the truth is to love it. So too, in giving the Ten Commandments to Moses and the People of Israel, Jehova just solemnly introduced Himself, reminding them at the same time of just a few of the outstanding favors that they could not but appreciate: "I am the Lord thy God who brought thee out of the land of Egypt and out of the land of bondage. Thou shalt not have strange gods before me...."

"Know the truth and the truth will make you free." At the time that Jesus proclaimed this doctrine to the Jews - this principal of Liberty from tyranny of hell, from turmoil among men, from the supreme climax of tragedy, - His own Cruel Crucifixion - which even then He knew them to be planning and which He foresaw that they would shortly execute, - at the time of this declaration about truth the world outside the comparatively tiny group of the "Chosen People", name of truth would seem to have been unknown; since even the Roman Governor seems never to heard the name before.

"What is truth?" he asks Jesus - "What is truth?" asked the Roman Governor and with that dismissed the whole question. Quite in similar manner the writer heard it asked: "What is religion?", with an identical dismissal. The very word Truth would seem to have been unknown, save among the comparatively tiny group of the Chosen People. "What is truth?" asked even the Roman Governor, and with that dismissing the whole question as of something entirely secondary in importance. Is it any wonder that at just such a time the whole world was in turmoil as never before, the climax in all creation - the claim of tragedy, of scandal.

(Unfinished draft)